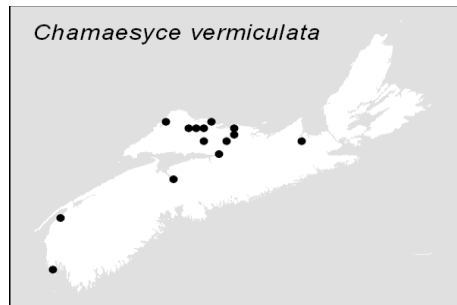


***Chamaesyce vermiculata* (Raf.) House**  
**Wormseed Sandmat; euphorbe vermiculée**



Photo by Sean Blaney



Sprawling from a basal rosette, this species bears ovate leaves with finely serrate margins. Stems may be armed with sparse straight pubescence. Ovary and fruit are glabrous.

Flowers from July until frost.

Associated with rail lines.

Yarmouth County, northeastward to the Northumberland Strait.

NS to ON and MI, south to IL and VA; AZ and NM.  
 Introduced to NS.

***Euphorbia* L.**  
**spurges**

These species are cosmopolitan, totalling 1500 species. As with *Chamaesyce*, they are typified by the very small unisexual flowers. Each pistillate flower bears a single pistil and is surrounded by several staminate flowers, each with a single stamen. All flowers are inserted into a lobed and glandular involucre forming a cyathium, functionally imitating a single flower — a character unique to this family. Ovary has three locules, ovules and styles. Schizocarp is three-lobed. Plants contain a very bitter latex.

**Key to species**

- |                                                                              |                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| A. Glands of the involucre ovate, elliptic or nearly round in cross-section. | <i>Euphorbia helioscopia</i> |
| aa. Glands kidney-shaped or crescent-shaped, concave side outside.           | B                            |
| B. Rays of the cyathium 3–5; annual.                                         | C                            |
| C. Seeds pitted; tubercles absent.                                           | <i>E. peplus</i>             |
| cc. Seeds smooth; tubercles present.                                         | <i>E. exigua</i>             |